

Major Service Outage Response Guide

1. Major Service Outage Definition

A Major Service Outage exists when a service event affects more than 2,500 customers, lasts longer than 4 hours, or impacts at least two regions. Once declared, the incident commander must assign a bridge lead, a communications lead, and a technical lead. The declaration must be logged in the operations system with a unique incident reference.

2. Command Bridge Procedures

The command bridge must open within 15 minutes of the Major Service Outage declaration. Participants must join with name, role, and organization. The bridge lead records decisions, action owners, and update times. If the outage continues beyond 6 hours, a senior manager must join the bridge and confirm the next restoration milestone.

3. Customer Update Policy

Public and direct customer updates must be issued at least every 2 hours during a Major Service Outage. Each update must explain the current status, the services affected, the estimated time to restore, and the next communication time. If restoration timing changes by more than 30 minutes, a revised update must be issued immediately.

4. Network Verification

Before closing a major incident, network teams must verify service restoration using live alarms, synthetic tests, and customer confirmations where available. Verification must continue for 30 minutes after the primary fix is applied. If alarms return during verification, the outage remains open and the recovery steps must be repeated.

5. Documentation Standards

Every major incident requires a final report within 2 business days. The report must include the impact summary, timeline, root cause, fix applied, lessons learned, and preventive actions. The final report should use plain language so both technical and business teams can review it quickly. All time references must be consistent across the report.

6. Preventive Actions

Preventive actions from major incident reviews must be assigned to a named owner and tracked until completion. Actions are expected to reduce repeat events, improve monitoring coverage, or shorten restoration time. Each action should include a due date no more than 30 days after approval, unless leadership approves an extension in writing.

7. Review Cadence

The major incident process is reviewed monthly by network operations leadership. Trends in outage duration, customer impact, and ticket escalation volume are assessed to identify where procedures need refinement. If

two or more Major Service Outages occur in the same region during a 60 day period, the regional escalation playbook must be updated.